

Hotels B2B Hub

Software Requirements Specification (SRS)

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1. Purpose

This document defines the high-level business scope, actors, modules, user flows, and open decisions for the Hotels B2B Hub platform.

The platform is intended to aggregate hotel inventory from multiple suppliers and make that inventory available to travel buyers through:

- A web portal for non-technical users
- A REST API for technical buyers that want system-to-system integration

This version is intentionally high level. It is designed to align product, business, and engineering stakeholders before moving into detailed functional specifications, solution design, and implementation planning.

2. Product Summary

Hotels B2B Hub is a B2B marketplace that sits between hotel inventory suppliers and travel buyers.

On the supply side, the platform connects to hotel wholesalers, bed banks, and OTAs through supplier APIs to retrieve live hotel rates and availability. It also supports manually uploaded static rate contracts from either the internal operations team or suppliers through a dedicated supplier interface.

On the distribution side, buyers such as OTAs, travel agencies, tour operators, and corporate travel managers can search, compare, and book hotel inventory through either the portal or the API.

The core value proposition is simple:

- Buyers access multiple supplier inventories from one place
- The platform aggregates and compares rates across suppliers
- The lowest available rate is shown by default
- Buyers can control which suppliers are enabled for their account

3. Scope

3.1 Phase 1 Scope

- Launch market: Saudi Arabia
- Languages: English
- Currencies: SAR and USD
- Buyer channels: web portal and REST API
- Supply channels: live supplier API integrations and static rate uploads
- Buyer controls: supplier preferences, markup rules, and team user management
- Admin capabilities: supplier onboarding, buyer onboarding, rate uploads, booking monitoring, and approval workflows

3.2 Planned Future Expansion

- GCC expansion: UAE, Kuwait, Bahrain, Qatar, and Oman
- Arabic language support
- Additional GCC currencies
- Direct hotel onboarding

3.3 Phase 1 Supplier List

- Hotelbeds
- WebBeds
- TBO
- itrip
- Within Earth

4. Business Context and Principles

4.1 Business Model Context

The platform serves travel businesses rather than end travelers. Buyers are resellers and are expected to add their own markup or service fee to supplier net rates before offering inventory to their own customers.

4.2 Pricing Principles

- Supplier net rates are the source rates received by the platform
- Buyers should be able to configure their own commercial pricing rules
- Buyer Users should only see the sellable price after buyer markup is applied
- The final platform revenue model is still pending decision (subscription, commission or revenue sharing?)

4.3 Operating Principle

The platform should provide a unified buying experience even when inventory is sourced from multiple supplier systems with different APIs, content quality, and pricing structures.

5. Actors and Roles

5.1 Suppliers

Suppliers are bed banks, wholesalers, and OTAs that provide hotel inventory to the platform. Suppliers may provide inventory in one of two ways:

- Live connectivity through their APIs
- Static contract uploads through the supplier portal

5.2 Buyers

Buyers are organizations that search, compare, and book hotels through the platform. Target buyer types include:

- OTAs
- Travel agencies
- Tour operators
- Corporate travel managers

Each buyer organization includes the following roles:

- Buyer Admin: Organization owner or manager. Manages account settings, users, supplier preferences, markup and service fee rules, and can view all bookings and invoices.
- Buyer User: Operational booking user. Searches hotels, creates bookings, views their own bookings, and sees marked-up prices only.

5.3 Platform Admin

Platform Admin users are internal team members who operate the system. They are responsible for:

- Onboarding suppliers and buyers
- Managing API configurations
- Uploading and validating static rates
- Monitoring bookings and transactions
- Reviewing supplier-uploaded content
- Handling operational issues and disputes
- Generating internal reports

5.4 Hotels

Hotels are indirect actors in Phase 1. They are represented through suppliers rather than onboarded directly into the platform.

6. Product Modules

6.1 Supplier Integration Module

The platform shall:

- Connect to Phase 1 suppliers through their APIs
- Pull live rates and availability during the buyer search flow
- Support future addition of new supplier integrations
- Allow supplier activation or deactivation by buyer account

6.2 Search and Aggregation Engine

The platform shall:

- Allow buyers to search by destination, check-in date, check-out date, room count, and occupancy
- Query all suppliers enabled for the buyer account
- Aggregate and normalize supplier responses
- Deduplicate the same hotel when it appears across multiple suppliers
- Display the lowest available rate by default
- Allow supplier-level comparison where relevant
- Honor each buyer's supplier inclusion and exclusion settings

6.3 Booking Engine

The platform shall:

Allow a buyer to select a hotel, room, and rate and submit a booking

Support booking confirmation

Support cancellation and amendment workflows

Store booking history by buyer account

The exact booking ownership model remains open and must be finalized before detailed requirements are written.

6.4 Buyer Portal

The portal shall provide:

- Login and account access for buyer users
- Hotel search and result browsing
- Hotel detail and rate detail views
- Booking creation
- Booking management, including view, cancel, and amend actions
- Supplier preference management for Buyer Admins
- Pricing rule management for Buyer Admins
- User management for Buyer Admins

6.5 Buyer API

The API shall provide:

- Search endpoints
- Booking endpoints
- Booking management endpoints
- Authentication through buyer-specific API credentials
- Usage limits and throttling controls
- Technical documentation for buyer integration teams

6.6 Static Rate Management

The platform shall support static rate ingestion from:

- Internal platform admins
- Suppliers through a supplier-facing upload workflow

The platform shall:

- Accept CSV and Excel uploads
- Validate file structure and content
- Store approved static rates in a searchable format
- Include approved static rates in aggregation and lowest-price logic

6.7 Buyer Markup and Service Fee Engine

Buyer Admins shall be able to configure markup rules using:

- Flat amount per booking
- Percentage on the supplier net rate

Rules shall be configurable:

- Globally
- Per supplier
- Per destination

Pricing visibility shall follow this model:

- Supplier net rate: Buyer Admin only
- Buyer sell rate after markup: Buyer Users and buyer end customers
- Platform margin or markup: Can be added by the buyer

6.8 Internal Admin Panel

The admin panel shall allow internal teams to:

- Manage supplier accounts and integration settings
- Manage buyer organizations
- Upload and maintain static rates
- Review supplier-uploaded static rates
- Monitor bookings and transactions
- Access operational reporting and analytics

6.9 Notification Service

Phase 1 notifications shall be email-based and include:

- Booking confirmations
- Cancellations
- Amendments
- Supplier notifications where required by the chosen booking model

7. Functional Flows

7.1 Buyer Search and Booking via Portal

1. A Buyer User signs in to the portal.
2. The user searches using destination, dates, room count, and occupancy.
3. The platform queries all suppliers enabled for that buyer account.
4. The system aggregates, deduplicates, and ranks results.
5. The portal displays the lowest rate per hotel by default and shows supplier context where applicable.
6. The user optionally adjusts supplier filters.
7. The user opens hotel and rate details, including room type and cancellation policy.
8. The user submits a booking request.
9. The system processes the booking according to the final booking ownership model.
10. The booking is recorded in booking history and a confirmation email is sent.

7.2 Buyer Search and Booking via API

1. The buyer's system submits a structured search request.
2. The platform returns aggregated hotel and rate results in JSON format.
3. The buyer's system submits a booking request for the selected rate.
4. The platform processes the booking and returns the booking outcome.

7.3 Static Rate Upload by Platform Admin

1. A Platform Admin logs in to the admin panel.
2. The admin uploads a CSV or Excel file containing hotel rates and conditions.
3. The system validates the file structure and content.
4. Validated rates are loaded and made available in search.

7.4 Static Rate Upload by Supplier

1. A supplier logs in to the supplier portal.
2. The supplier uploads a rate file.
3. The system flags the upload for review.

4. A Platform Admin reviews and approves or rejects the submission.
5. Approved rates become available in search.

7.5 Buyer Onboarding

1. A Platform Admin creates a buyer organization.
2. The buyer's initial Buyer Admin receives access credentials.
3. The Buyer Admin configures users, supplier preferences, and markup rules.
4. The buyer account becomes operational for search and booking.

7.6 Buyer Pricing Configuration

1. A Buyer Admin opens pricing settings.
2. The admin creates or updates markup rules.
3. The system applies those rules to pricing presented to Buyer Users.
4. Buyer Users continue to see only the marked-up sell rate.

8. Assumptions

The following assumptions are currently being made in this document:

- Supplier APIs can return the minimum data required for search, pricing, room details, and booking operations
- Static rate uploads can be normalized into the same commercial model used by live supplier responses
- Buyers are managed as organizations with multiple internal users
- Buyer-specific supplier preferences apply consistently across both the portal and the API
- Email is sufficient for Phase 1 operational notifications

9. Open Decisions and Business Questions

The following items must be resolved before detailed design and delivery planning:

1. Booking ownership model: live booking vs. pass-through. Determines liability, operational ownership, cancellation handling, supplier obligations, and booking workflow design.
2. Platform revenue model. Affects pricing logic, commercial configuration, invoicing, and finance reporting.
3. Payment and settlement model. Impacts payment gateway design, reconciliation, credit management, and settlement operations.
4. Hotel deduplication strategy. Directly affects search quality, customer trust, and content normalization effort.
5. Supplier rate refresh strategy. Impacts system performance, response time, cache design, and pricing accuracy.

10. Out of Scope for Phase 1

The following capabilities are excluded from the initial release:

- Direct hotel onboarding without an intermediary supplier
- Arabic UI and content support
- Support for additional GCC currencies such as AED, KWD, BHD, QAR, and OMR
- Mobile applications for buyers
- Advanced reporting and analytics dashboards
- Loyalty or rewards programs
- Dynamic packaging such as hotel plus flight bundles
- Fully self-service supplier onboarding

11. Glossary

- Bed Bank: A wholesale hotel inventory provider that aggregates hotel rooms and sells them to travel businesses
- Net Rate: The supplier-provided rate before buyer markup or service fees are applied
- Marked-up Rate: The rate shown after the buyer's pricing rules are applied
- Static Rate: A rate uploaded manually rather than pulled live from a supplier API
- Aggregation: Combining inventory from multiple suppliers into one unified search response
- Deduplication: Identifying and merging the same hotel across multiple sources
- Pass-through Booking: A model where the platform facilitates the transaction but the booking is held directly with the supplier
- Live Booking: A model where the platform places and manages the booking with the supplier on behalf of the buyer

